

Word family: **volume / volumes / volumetric / voluminous**

Base word: volume

Plural: volumes

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

volumetric (adj.) — 體積的；按體積計算的

voluminous (adj.) — 大量的；篇幅很長的；體積龐大的

volumetrically (adv.) — 以體積方式

Useful expressions / extensions:

the volume of a container

volume of water / air / gas

sales volume

traffic volume

trading volume

production volume

sound volume

turn the volume up/down

a volume of a book

a two-volume work

speak volumes

speak volumes about

in volume

high-volume / low-volume

Meaning in this passage

Your sentence is:

> That moment **spoke volumes**.

Here, **volume** is part of the fixed expression:

speak volumes — 顯示很多；充分說明；很能說明問題

The meaning is:

to reveal a great deal without needing many words — 不用多說，就已經充分顯示出很多事情

So:

> That moment **spoke volumes**.

means:

> **那一刻已經充分反映出很多事情。**

More specifically in the passage:

> **那一刻充分顯示出 Leo 的性格。**

This is **figurative**. It has nothing to do with physical size, sound level, or books.

1. **volume (體積) — 體積 ; 容量**

This is one of the core technical meanings.

Practice 1

> What is the **volume** of this box?

這個盒子的**體積**是多少？

Practice 2

> The tank has a **volume** of 500 litres.

這個水箱的**容量 / 體積**是 500 公升。

MCQ-ready definition:

volume = 某物佔據空間的大小，即體積

2. **volume of liquid/gas — 液體 / 氣體的量**

Practice 1

> Measure the **volume of water** in the container.

量度容器內水的**體積**。

Practice 2

> The gas expands to twice its original **volume**.

氣體膨脹至原本**體積**的兩倍。

MCQ-ready definition:

volume = 液體、氣體等所佔的空間大小

3. **volume (數量 / 規模) — 數量 ; 總量**

This is a major abstract extension.

Practice 1

> The company handles a large **volume of orders** every day.

公司每天處理大量**訂單**。

Practice 2

> The **volume of complaints** increased last month.

上個月的**投訴數量**增加了。

MCQ-ready definition:

volume = 某種事物在一段時間內的總數量或規模

4. **sales volume — 銷售量**

Practice 1

> Sales **volume** increased by 20 percent.

銷售量增加了百分之二十。

Practice 2

> The company wants to raise its annual sales **volume**.

公司希望提高年度**銷售量**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****sales volume = 在某段期間內售出的產品或服務總量****

5. ****traffic volume — 交通流量****

Practice 1

> Traffic ****volume**** is highest during rush hour.

繁忙時間的****交通流量****最高。

Practice 2

> The road was redesigned to handle greater traffic ****volumes****.

這條道路重新設計，以應付更大的****車流量****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****traffic volume = 某段時間內通過某地點的車輛數量****

6. ****trading volume — 成交量；交易量****

Finance/business use.

Practice 1

> Trading ****volume**** rose sharply after the announcement.

公布消息後，****成交量****大幅上升。

Practice 2

> The stock had unusually high trading ****volume****.

這隻股票的****交易量****異常高。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trading volume = 某段期間內完成的交易總量****

7. ****production volume — 生產量****

Practice 1

> The factory increased its production **volume**.

工廠提高了**生產量**。

Practice 2

> Lower demand led to reduced production **volumes**.

需求下降導致**生產量**減少。

MCQ-ready definition:

production volume = 某段時間內生產的產品總量

8. **sound volume — 音量**

This is one of the most common everyday meanings.

Practice 1

> Please turn the **volume** down.

請把**音量**調低。

Practice 2

> The television **volume** is too loud.

電視的**音量**太大了。

MCQ-ready definition:

volume = 聲音的大小或響度

9. **turn the volume up/down — 把音量調高 / 調低**

Practice 1

> Can you turn the **volume up**?

你可以把**音量調高**嗎？

Practice 2

> He turned the **volume down** so the baby could sleep.

他把**音量調低**，讓嬰兒可以睡覺。

MCQ-ready definition:

turn the volume up/down = 調高或調低聲音的響度

10. **at full volume** — 以最大音量

Practice 1

> The music was playing at **full volume**.

音樂正以**最大音量**播放。

Practice 2

> He shouted at **full volume**.

他以**最大聲量**大喊。

MCQ-ready definition:

at full volume = 以非常大或最大的聲音播放 / 說話

11. **a volume** (一本書 ; 一冊) — 卷 ; 冊 ; 本

A completely different lexical branch.

Practice 1

> She bought the first **volume** of the series.

她買了這套系列的第一**冊**。

Practice 2

> The encyclopedia consists of ten **volumes**.

這套百科全書共有十**卷**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****volume = 一套書中的其中一冊，或一本獨立成冊的書****

12. ****a two-volume / multi-volume work — 兩卷本 / 多卷本作品****

Practice 1

> The biography was published as a two-****volume**** work.

這本傳記以****兩卷本****形式出版。

Practice 2

> The history is a six-****volume**** series.

這套歷史著作共有****六卷****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****volume = 一套大型著作中的單獨一冊****

13. ****speak volumes — 充分說明；不言自明地顯示很多****

This is the expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — passage sense

> That moment ****spoke volumes****.

那一刻已經****充分說明了很多事情****。

Practice 2

> Her silence ****spoke volumes****.

她的沉默已經****說明了一切 / 透露了很多****。

Practice 3

> His reaction ****spoke volumes about his character****.

他的反應****充分反映了他的性格****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speak volumes = 雖然沒有直接說明，但某個行為、反應或情況已經透露出大量資訊****

14. ****speak volumes about someone/something — 充分反映.....****

Practice 1

> The way she treated the staff ****spoke volumes about her character****.

她對待員工的方式****充分反映了她的性格****。

Practice 2

> His willingness to help ****speaks volumes about him****.

他願意幫忙這件事****很能說明他的為人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speak volumes about X = 某個行為或現象已充分反映 X 的本質、態度或情況****

15. ****high-volume / low-volume — 大量的 / 少量的****

Practice 1

> This factory specializes in ****high-volume production****.

這間工廠專門進行****大量生產****。

Practice 2

> The system is designed for ****low-volume transactions****.

這個系統是為****低交易量****而設計。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****high-/low-volume = 涉及大量 / 少量活動、產量或交易的****

16. ****in volume — 大量地；大批量地****

Practice 1

> The product is cheaper when purchased **in volume**.

這種產品**大量購買**時會較便宜。

Practice 2

> The company can manufacture the parts **in volume**.

公司可以**大量生產**這些零件。

MCQ-ready definition:

in volume = 以大量、批量方式

17. **volumetric** — 體積的；按體積計算的

Technical/scientific.

Practice 1

> The engineer carried out a **volumetric analysis**.

工程師進行了**體積分析**。

Practice 2

> The fee is based on **volumetric weight**.

費用是按**體積重量**計算。

MCQ-ready definition:

volumetric = 與體積、容量或按體積測量有關的

18. **voluminous** — 大量的；篇幅很長的；體積龐大的

This is related historically but has developed its own modern meanings.

Practice 1

> The investigation produced **voluminous records**.

調查產生了**大量文件紀錄**。

Practice 2

> She wore a **voluminous skirt**.

她穿着一條**寬大蓬鬆的裙子**。

MCQ-ready definition:

voluminous = 數量、篇幅或體積非常大的

Important distinction 1: **volume = size in space vs amount**

Physical

> the **volume** of the box

盒子的**體積**

Abstract quantity

> a large **volume** of emails

大量電郵

The second develops from the idea of a large physical mass/quantity, but in modern English it functions as a broad measure of amount.

Important distinction 2: **volume vs capacity**

volume

how much space something actually occupies.

capacity

how much something **can contain**.

For example:

> The bottle has a **capacity** of one litre.

瓶子容量是一公升。

> The water currently has a **volume** of half a litre.

目前水的體積是半公升。

In everyday usage they can overlap, but technically the distinction matters.

Important distinction 3: **volume** vs **amount**

amount

very broad quantity word.

> a large **amount** of work

大量工作

volume

often suggests a measurable quantity, throughput, flow, or total over time.

> a high **volume** of calls

大量來電

So **volume** often sounds more businesslike, technical, or quantitative.

Important distinction 4: **volume** vs **number**

number

used specifically with countable things.

> the **number** of customers

顧客人數

volume

focuses on overall quantity or throughput.

> the **volume** of customer enquiries

顧客查詢量

The two can overlap in meaning, but **volume** sounds broader and often more operational.

Important distinction 5: **volume** vs **loudness**

In everyday English:

> turn up the **volume**

is standard.

Technically, **loudness** refers more directly to perceived sound intensity, while **volume** is the ordinary control/display word.

So:

* **volume** → 音量

* **loudness** → 響度 / 感知上的聲音大小

Important distinction 6: **a volume** vs **a book**

book

broad everyday word.

volume

often means:

* one book in a multi-book set

* a more formal single bound work

> Volume 2 of the encyclopedia

百科全書第二卷

So not every book needs to be called a **volume**.

Important distinction 7: ****speak volumes vs say a lot****

These are close.

****say a lot****

very broad:

> His reaction ****says a lot about him****.

他的反應很能說明他的為人。

****speak volumes****

more idiomatic and emphatic:

> His reaction ****speaks volumes about him****.

他的反應**充分**說明了他的為人**。**

****Speak volumes**** often suggests that the evidence is ****indirect but very revealing****.

Important distinction 8: ****speak volumes does not mean speak loudly****

This is especially important because ****volume**** also means sound level.

> Her silence ****spoke volumes****.

does ****not**** mean:

> 她的沉默聲音很大 ❌

It means:

> 她的沉默**透露**了很多 / 已經很能說明問題**。**

So this idiom is fully figurative.

Important distinction 9: ****volume vs intensity****

****volume****

often quantity or sound level.

intensity

strength or degree.

> high **traffic volume**

車流量大

> high traffic **intensity**

less natural in ordinary English

But:

> high **intensity** exercise

高強度運動

So they measure different things.

Family-extension note

Volume is a strong polysemy candidate because it has several genuinely distinct modern branches:

1. **physical space**

- * volume of a box
- * volume of water

2. **quantity / throughput**

- * sales volume
- * traffic volume
- * trading volume

3. **sound level**

- * turn up the volume

4. **book / part of a series**

- * Volume 1
- * a multi-volume work

5. **figurative idiom**

- * speak volumes

The **speak volumes** branch is especially important here because it is highly idiomatic: the literal noun **volume** is not being used transparently. The phrase means that something **reveals a great deal without explicit explanation**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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volume of a box	體積	space occupied	
volume of water	體積 / 容量	amount of space	
volume of orders	訂單量	total quantity	
sales volume	銷售量	sales quantity	
traffic volume	交通流量	number/flow of vehicles	
trading volume	成交量	amount traded	
production volume	生產量	amount produced	
sound volume	音量	loudness level	
turn the volume up/down	調高 / 調低音量	adjust sound level	
at full volume	以最大音量	maximum sound	
a volume	一卷；一冊	book/unit in a set	
multi-volume work	多卷本著作	multiple books	
speak volumes	充分說明；透露很多	reveal much indirectly	
speak volumes about X	充分反映 X	strongly indicate	
high-volume	大量的	high quantity	
low-volume	少量的	low quantity	
in volume	大批量地	in large quantities	
volumetric	體積的	related to volume	
voluminous	大量的；龐大的	very large in size/amount	

For your original sentence

> That moment **spoke volumes**.

Here:

speak volumes = 不用多說，已經充分顯示出很多事情

The subject is **that moment** — the moment when Leo's bridge was broken and, instead of crying, he smiled and said:

> “That's okay, we can build a better one.”

That reaction reveals a lot about him:

- * he is not easily upset,
- * he is generous,
- * he is resilient,
- * he looks for a constructive response.

So:

> **That moment spoke volumes.**

means naturally:

> **那一刻已經充分反映出他的性格。**

or:

> **那一刻已經說明了很多事情。**

The key sense here is therefore the fixed figurative expression **speak volumes**, not literal **volume = 體積 / 音量 / 一冊書**.